

After Scaling & Gum Care

Simple after-care instructions to help your gums recover and stay healthy

WHAT IS NORMAL?

Mild gum tenderness, slight bleeding and temporary sensitivity can occur after scaling, especially when there was inflammation or heavier deposits. Your gums should gradually feel more comfortable.

REMEMBER

Healthy gums need daily care. Scaling removes deposits that brushing cannot remove, but regular brushing, cleaning between the teeth and dental reviews help prevent them from building up again.

1. Immediately after scaling

- Follow the specific instructions given by your dentist or hygienist.
- If your gums feel tender, choose softer foods for the rest of the day.
- Avoid very hot foods and drinks if your teeth feel sensitive.
- If your gums bleed slightly, gentle brushing should generally continue rather than stopping oral hygiene completely.

2. Brushing

- Brush twice daily with a soft-bristled toothbrush and fluoride toothpaste.
- Use gentle, controlled movements along the gumline rather than brushing aggressively.
- Do not scrub harder because the gums are bleeding. Persistent bleeding should be assessed by your dentist.

3. Cleaning between the teeth

- Clean between your teeth every day using floss or an appropriate interdental brush.
- Your dentist may recommend a particular size or method depending on the spaces between your teeth and your gum health.
- Regular interdental cleaning helps prevent plaque from accumulating where a toothbrush cannot reach effectively.

4. Sensitivity

- Temporary sensitivity to cold can occur after deposits are removed, particularly when previously covered root surfaces become exposed.
- Avoid very cold or very hot foods if they trigger discomfort.
- Use a desensitising toothpaste if recommended by your dentist.

5. Keep your gums healthy

- Plaque can build up again after a professional cleaning, so daily home care is essential.
- Do not rely on scaling alone. Long-term gum health depends on regular plaque control and appropriate professional monitoring.
- Avoid tobacco products, which can adversely affect gum health and healing.

6. When should you contact us?

- **Contact your dentist if you develop:**
 - Persistent or heavy bleeding
 - Severe or increasing pain
 - Significant swelling
 - Persistent pus, bad taste or foul smell
 - Loose teeth or a noticeable change in how your teeth bite

- Symptoms that are not improving as expected

Important: These are general patient-education instructions and do not replace personalised advice from your dentist. The frequency of professional cleaning and periodontal follow-up depends on your individual gum health.

References

1. American Dental Association. Oral Health Topics: Periodontal Disease. Patient information.
2. American Dental Association. Oral Health Topics: Floss. Patient information.
3. European Federation of Periodontology. Periodontal health and prevention of periodontal diseases: patient and professional guidance.